Can for ability

Nombre: _____ Fecha: _____

Qué vas a aprender

- Say what you can and can't do
- Use can with all persons, always the same
- Ask «Can you...?» and answer «Yes, I can / No, I can't»
- Talk about the abilities of animals and robots

Para pensar

Un pájaro vuela, pero no sabe leer. Tú sabes leer, pero no vuelas. ¿Qué palabra mágica del inglés sirve para decir lo que cada uno sabe hacer?

Explicación

I can!

We use *can* to talk about **abilities**: things we are able to do. «I **can** run.» «I **can** sing.» «I **can** count to one hundred.» After *can*, we put the verb: **can + run**, **can + swim**.

En castellano: *can* significa «saber» o «poder»: «I can swim» = «sé nadar». Es uno de los verbos más útiles del inglés. Di en voz alta tres cosas que *can* hacer: «I can… I can… I can…!»



Action verbs

We need *action verbs* to talk about abilities: **run** (correr), **jump** (saltar), **swim** (nadar), **fly** (volar), **climb** (trepar), **dance** (bailar), **sing** (cantar), **skip** (saltar a la comba), **ride a bike** (montar en bici), **play the piano**, **draw** (dibujar) and **cook** (cocinar).

Play **Action mime**: one child mimes a verb and the class guesses: «You can swim!». Moverte te ayuda a recordar las palabras.



Can is the same for everybody

Can is very easy: it **never changes**. I can, you can, **he can**, **she can**, **it can**, we can, they can. We never add -s: «She **can** dance», not «she cans dance».

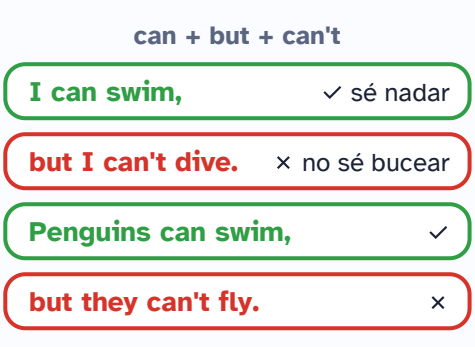
And the verb after *can* doesn't change either: «He can **swim**», not «he can swims» or «he can to swim». **Truco:** piensa que *can* es como un ayudante que siempre va igual vestido, con cualquier persona.

person	can + verb
I / you	can swim
he / she	can swim
it	can swim
we / they	can swim

I can't

To say that we are **not** able to do something, we use can't (**cannot**): «I **can't** fly.» «My baby brother **can't** walk.» «Fish **can't** climb trees.»

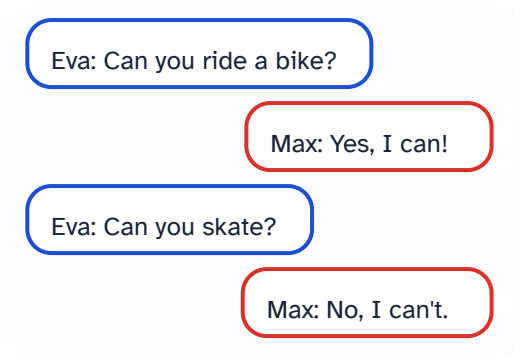
We can join two sentences with but (pero): «I can swim, **but** I can't dive.» «Penguins can swim, **but** they can't fly.» **Pronunciación:** escucha bien la **t** final: *can* (sí) y *can't* (no) suenan parecido.



Can you...?

To ask about abilities, put Can first: «**Can you** ride a bike?», «**Can your dog** jump?», «**Can they** speak English?».

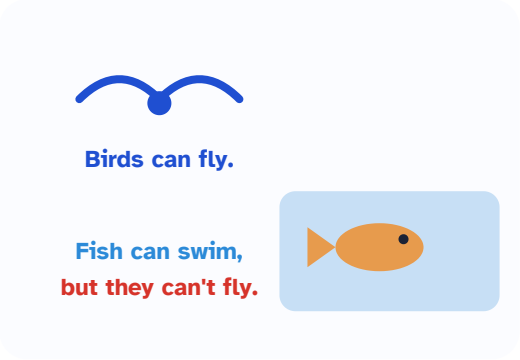
The short answers are: **Yes, I can.** / **No, I can't.**; **Yes, it can.** / **No, it can't. En castellano:** «¿Sabes montar en bici?» → «Can you ride a bike?». Solo cambias el orden: *can* va delante de la persona.



Animals can...

Animals have got amazing abilities. «Birds **can** fly.» «Fish **can** swim.» «Monkeys **can** climb trees.» «Kangaroos **can** jump very high.» «Parrots **can** talk.» «Cheetahs **can** run very fast.»

But they can't do everything: «Elephants **can't** jump.» «Snakes **can't** walk.» «Penguins **can't** fly.» **Reto:** piensa en tu animal favorito y di una cosa que *can* y otra que *can't* hacer.

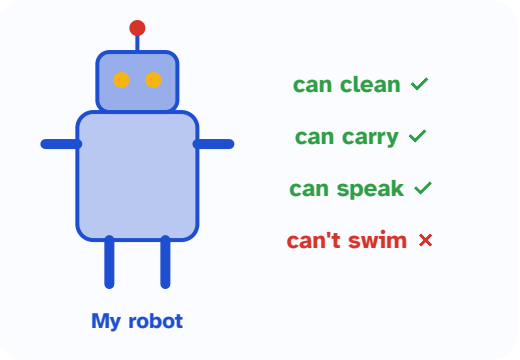


Robots and superheroes

Let's imagine! A **robot** can do many things: «My robot **can** clean my room. It **can** carry heavy boxes. It **can** speak ten languages. But it **can't** swim: water is dangerous for robots!»

And a **superhero**? «Super Lola **can** fly and she **can** run faster than a car. She **can** see through walls. She **can't** cook!» Inventa tu propio robot o superhéroe y di tres

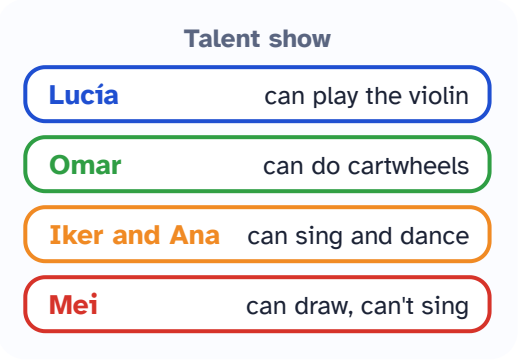
cosas que *can* y una que *can't*.



Reading: the school talent show

Read the poster: «**Talent Show** on Friday! Come and see the stars of class 3A. **Lucía** can play the violin. **Omar** can do ten cartwheels (volteretas laterales). **Iker and Ana** can sing and dance. **Mei** can't sing, but she can draw a portrait in one minute! And our headteacher can juggle with three balls!»

Answer: What can Omar do? Can Mei sing? Who can play the violin?



Let's practise: Find someone who can…

Play **Find someone who can…** Your card says: whistle (silbar), touch your toes, count to 20 in English, stand on one foot, say the alphabet. Walk around and ask: «**Can you whistle?**» If the answer is «**Yes, I can**», they show you and you write their name.

At the end, tell the class: «Pablo can whistle. Sara can stand on one foot. Nobody can say the alphabet backwards!» ¡Gana quien complete la tarjeta antes!

Find someone who can...

- **whistle** — Pablo
- **touch your toes** — Sara
- **count to 20** _____
- **stand on one foot** _____

Can for ability

sí sé	no sé	pregunta	unir
CAN	**CAN'T**	**CAN YOU...?**	**BUT**
I can swim. She can sing.	I can't fly. = cannot	Can you skate? Yes, I can.	I can run, but I can't fly.

Ejercicios

1. **Traduce: correr, saltar, trepar, volar.**

2. **Completa: «Birds ___ fly.»**

3. **Completa: «Fish ___ walk.» (no)**

4. **Pregunta: «your sister / sing».**

5. **Respuesta corta (sí): «Can you dance?»**

6. **Respuesta corta (no): «Can it fly?»**

7. **Une con but: «I can draw.» «I can't paint.»**

8. **Corrige: «He can plays tennis.»**

9. **Escribe una cosa que un pingüino can y otra que can't.**

10. **Escribe tres cosas que sabes hacer.**

Practica

1. **«Sé nadar» is...**

   A) I swim can.

   B) I can swim.

   C) I cans swim.

2. **Birds ___ fly.**

   A) can

   B) cans

   C) can to

3. **Elephants ___ jump.**

   A) can

   B) cans

   C) can't

4. **She can ___.**

   A) dances

   B) to dance

   C) dance

5. **«Can you skate?» — «Yes, ...»**

   A) I can.

   B) I do.

   C) I am.

6. **«Can it swim?» — «No, ...»**

   A) it isn't.

   B) it can't.

   C) it don't.

7. **«Trepar» is...**

   A) climb

   B) jump

   C) fly

8. **___ you ride a bike?**

   A) Do

B) Are

C) Can

9. **I can sing, ___ I can't dance.**

A) and

B) but

C) or

10. **«Cannot» is the same as...**

A) can

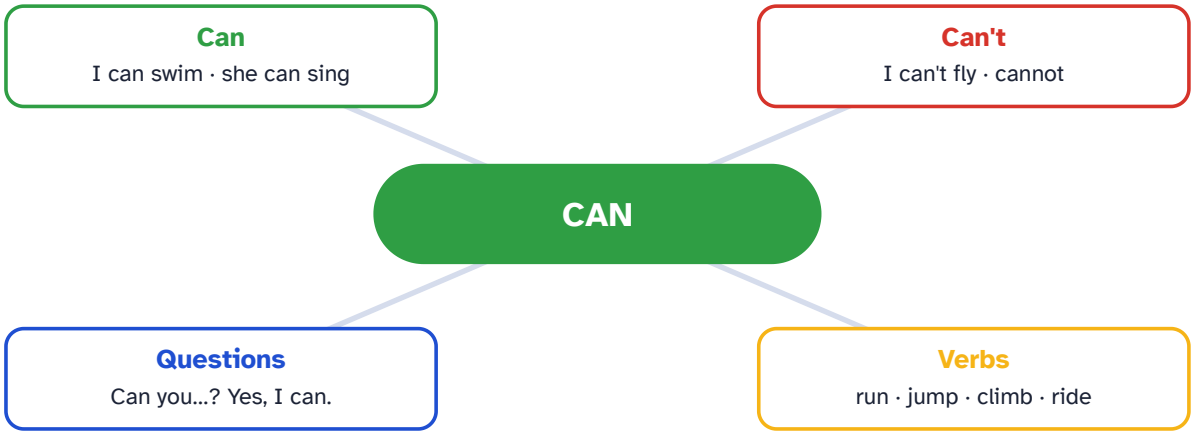
B) can't

C) can not to

Explícalo con tus palabras

Incluye: Para qué sirve can; Por qué can no cambia con ninguna persona; Cómo se dice lo que no sé hacer y cómo uno frases con but; Cómo pregunto Can you...? y respondo.

Resumen



Tarjetas de repaso

Recórtalas: pregunta delante, respuesta detrás.

can

Saber / poder hacer algo.

can't (cannot)

No saber / no poder.

Can you…?

¿Sabes…? ¿Puedes…?

Yes, I can. / No, I can't.

Respuestas cortas.

can + verbo

Sin -s y sin to: she can swim.

but

Pero: I can run, but I can't fly.

climb

Trepar.

ride a bike

Montar en bici.

Soluciones

1. **B)** Can + verbo.
2. **A)** Can.
3. **C)** No pueden.
4. **C)** Verbo sin -s.
5. **A)** Yes, I can.
6. **B)** It can't.
7. **A)** Climb.
8. **C)** Can delante.
9. **B)** Contraste: but.
10. **B)** Can't.

Soluciones de los ejercicios

1. run, jump, climb, fly.
2. can.
3. can't.
4. Can your sister sing?
5. Yes, I can.
6. No, it can't.
7. I can draw, but I can't paint.
8. He can play tennis.
9. Penguins can swim, but they can't fly.
10. Model answer: I can ride a bike. I can swim. I can play the guitar.